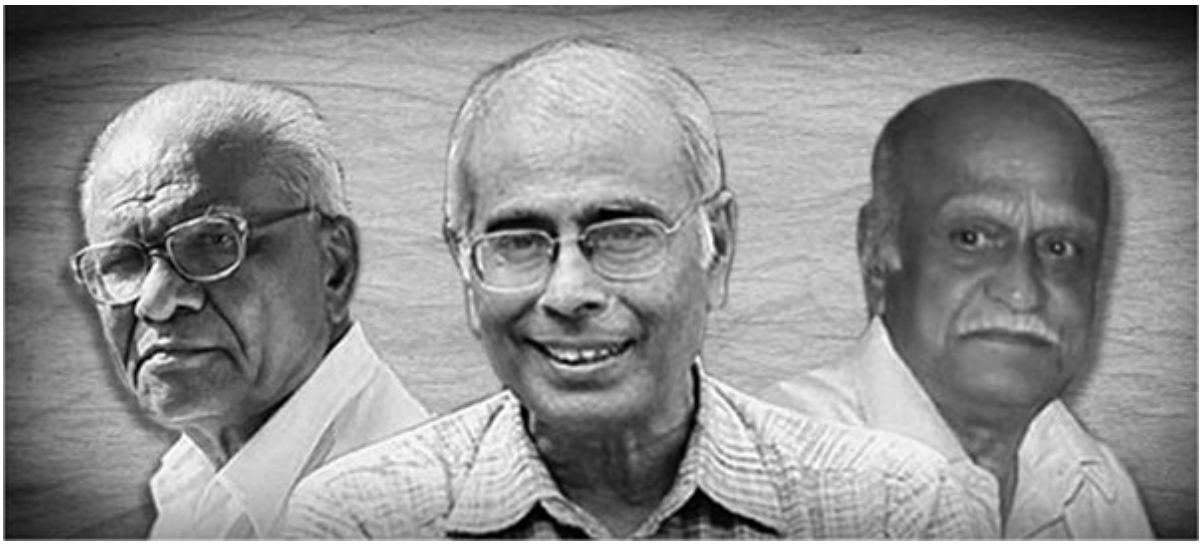
Kolhapur. To my knowledge, no one has yet been charged for their murders.[32]



Three secularist intellectuals murdered between 2013 and 2015 for their allegedly anti-Hindu views: (from left to right) Govind Pansare, Narendra Dabholkar and M. M. Kalburgi.

I grew up in India unconscious of the diversity around me, but in my parents' house in 1947 my ayah or nanny was a Christian Khasi, the cook a Buddhist, the head of the staff a Muslim and the rest of the staff a mix of Hindus from the plains and animists from the hills, with – I'm sad to say – the lowliest posts being filled by 'sweeper' outcastes. They were a microcosm of India itself, and there were at that time a great many doom-mongers among my parents' generation who prophesied that once the external authority represented by people like my father was withdrawn that Indian macrocosm would quickly disintegrate into its constituent parts. It didn't happen, and now as India celebrates seventy years of independence I can only marvel at how that seemingly fragile democracy continues to prosper and how the Indian Constitution still holds firm despite all the divisive forces.

However, the arrival of the digital age and electronic media has given rise to what is now being described as a